

CANNELLONI

REGION

Found across Italy, most notably Emilia-Romagna (meat filling under béchamel), Abruzzo, Tuscany, and Campania

METHOD

1. Make your chosen egg-based dough, then roll and sheet it.
2. Dust a wooden board with 00 flour. Cover a sheet pan with parchment, then dust the parchment with semolina.
3. Cut the sheets into 5 by 7-inch rectangles with a plain pastry cutter, trimming away the ragged edges. Save the scraps for soup. A knife and ruler work too.
4. Separate the rectangles, give each a light dusting of 00 flour, and stack them in groups on the prepared pan. Dust the pan again with semolina.
5. Boil a large pot of water and salt it generously. Line a second sheet pan with parchment and brush the paper with a little olive oil.
6. Blanch the sheets about 1 minute, so they turn tender without going soft. Lift them out with a spider and lay them flat in a single layer on the oiled pan, separating layers with lightly oiled parchment.
7. Line and oil a third sheet pan the same way. Clean off the board. Put one cooked sheet down lengthwise in front of you. Using a pastry bag cut to a 1-inch opening, pipe a line of filling 1/2 inch in from either side and 1 inch up from the bottom edge.
8. Fold the bottom edge over the filling, pressing with your thumbs so the pasta hugs it, then roll the sheet over itself again into a cylinder.
9. Set the finished tube seam side down on the oiled pan.
10. Work through the remaining sheets the same way, setting each finished tube on that oiled pan.
11. To hold, cover with plastic wrap and refrigerate up to 24 hours.

SHAPING



NOTES

Sheets are cut 5 by 7 inches with a plain pastry cutter, one tube per rectangle.

The sheets get blanched for roughly a minute before filling, then held flat on lightly oiled parchment with more oiled parchment between the layers.

Filling per piece: one line piped through a 1-inch opening, inset 1/2 inch from each side and 1 inch up from the bottom edge.

Seal: no crimp or pinch at all. The bottom edge folds over the filling and the sheet rolls over itself once more, and the tube rests seam side down.

No drying step and no dusting of the finished tubes. They sit on oiled parchment, covered, for up to 24 hours in the refrigerator.

This is a baked pasta. It gets assembled in a pan and finished in the oven rather than boiled and sauced.

Served Italian American style, filled with cheese and spinach and topped with red sauce and more cheese.

DOUGH

Egg Dough

Makes: 954 g / Active Time: 8-10 min kneading / Rest: 30 min minimum, wrapped

INGREDIENTS

500 g	Tipo 00 flour
454 g	Egg yolks
as needed	Extra 00 flour for kneading
up to 1 tbsp, only if dry	Room-temperature water

METHOD

1. Mix the yolks lightly, without beating them.
2. Mound the flour on a wooden surface and open a well 5 to 6 inches across. Wider than that and the walls collapse.
3. Add half the yolks, drawing in flour from the inner wall with a fork, working round the circumference.
4. Add the rest the same way. If the wall breaks, scrape the escape back into the flour until the mass holds itself.
5. Knead 8 to 10 minutes: press down and away with the heel of your hand, rotate 180 degrees, fold, repeat. Scrape your hands and the board as you go.
6. Add water a tablespoon at a time only if it stays dry and refuses to come together.
7. Stop when it is smooth, firm, and springs back slightly when poked. The texture to aim for is Play-Doh.
8. Wrap and rest at least 30 minutes before rolling.

NOTES

454 g of yolks is roughly 24 to 26 eggs, so plan what the whites are for.
 Yolks only, no whites and no whole eggs, which is what makes this rich and tender rather than elastic.
 Dry winter air is the usual reason it will not come together. Flour the board sparingly, since excess dries it out.
 Keeps 24 hours. Chilled overnight, pull it out 20 minutes before rolling.

DATE ____ / ____ / ____

RATING ____ / 5

OVEN ADJ _____

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